Choose the good way

Starter lesson 01 · Psalm 1:1–2 · 30 minutes

Read from your Bible: Psalm 1:1–2 in NIV or Good News Bible (GNB).

Lesson summary, not a Bible quotation: God's teaching helps us consider the advice we follow and the choices we make. We can enjoy learning his ways.

Today's learning goal

Explain the difference between following unhelpful advice and enjoying God's teaching, then practise one thoughtful choice.

Before the children arrive

Have a Bible, crayons or pencils and these pages ready. Cut the cards on page 5. No internet or special equipment is needed.

A lesson you can lead

4 min **Welcome.** Ask: Who helps you learn something new? Gather several answers.

5 min **Read.** Read Psalm 1:1–2 in NIV or GNB. Discuss advice, delight and thinking about God's teaching.

8 min **Discover.** Complete page 3 in pairs. Discuss the reasons behind each choice.

7 min **Create.** Draw a choice on the path on page 4 and tell a partner about it.

6 min **Respond.** Use two action cards, choose a weekly practice and pray.

Keep the message caring

Talk about helpful or harmful actions, not "good children" and "bad children". Welcome questions. Explain that we can apologise, ask for help and try again. This passage is not a promise that life will always be easy.

A little time together

A family conversation · 12 minutes · A Bible and a willing grownup

Read, talk and try

3 min Read the passage together. Explain delight as taking pleasure in something.

5 min Choose one scenario on page 3. Ask what the choice could do to another person.

4 min Pick an action card and plan when to try it. Pray and check in tomorrow.

Questions with room for different answers

Is every idea from a friend helpful?

Grownup guidance: No. Think about the action, ask a trusted grownup and compare it with God’s teaching.

How could you enjoy God’s teaching today?

Grownup guidance: Read, listen, ask a question or act on something you have learned.

One practice for the week

At the end of each day, name one helpful choice and one thing you can practise tomorrow.

A prayer to say together

Dear God, thank you for teaching me. Help me pause, listen and choose what is kind and true. Help me learn when I make a mistake. Amen.

Our family’s idea

What will we try, and when?

Pause. Think. Choose.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Circle a helpful response. Then tell someone why.

1. A friend says, “Hide the crayons so only we can draw.”

A. Hide them.
B. Suggest taking turns.

2. Someone is being left out of a game.

A. Ask how they could join.
B. Laugh and walk away.

3. You broke a cup by accident.

A. Ask a grownup to help and tell the truth.
B. Blame another child.

Complete the idea in your own words:

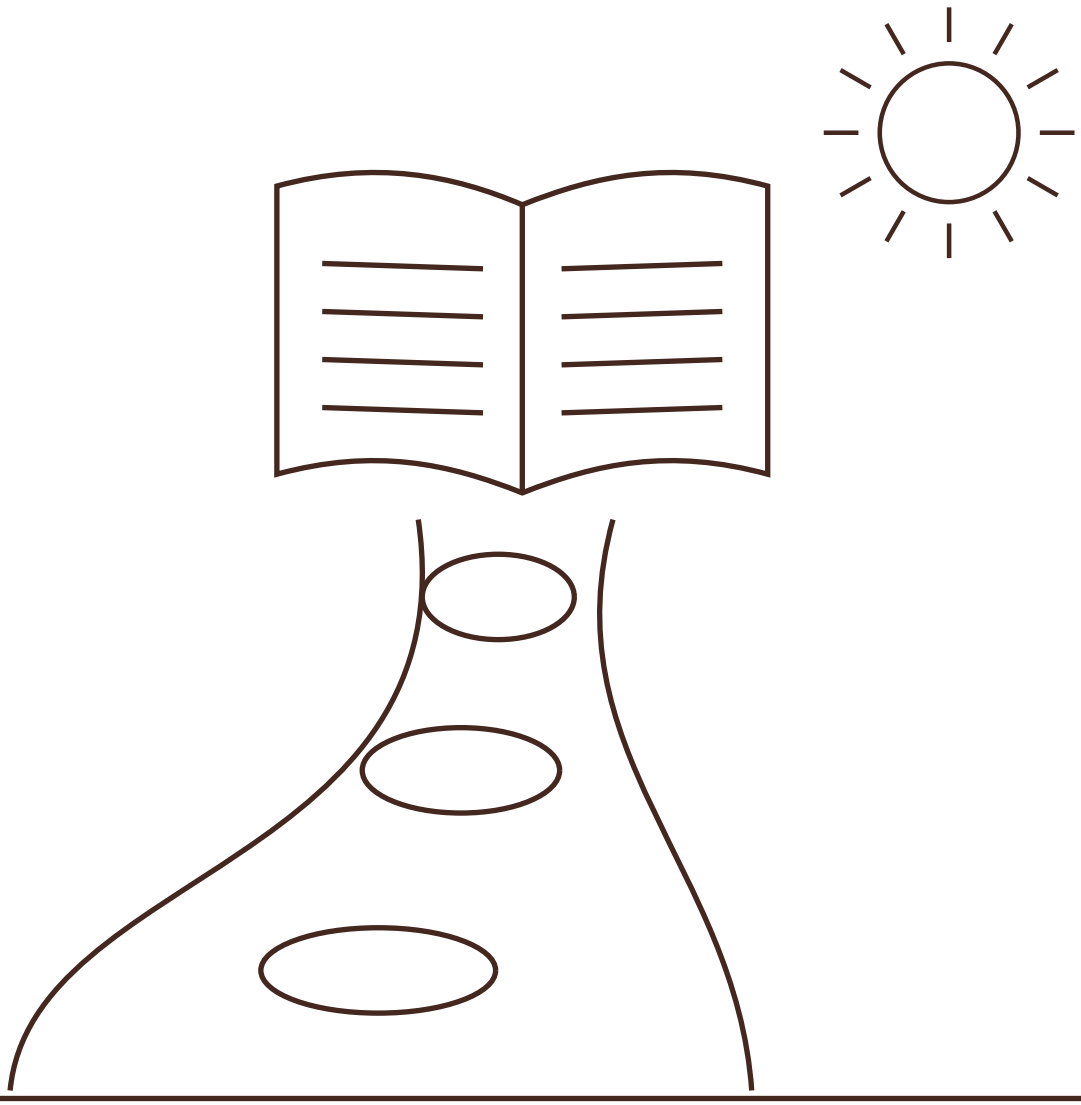
God’s teaching can help me when _____

Make your good way

Read Psalm 1:1–2 together before starting.

Colour the scene. On the path, draw one choice you will practise. Beside the Bible, write or draw something you want to learn.

My ideas can go anywhere inside this frame.



My next helpful choice: _____

Grownup note: this drawing supports discussion. The path and sun are illustrations, not a picture described in verses 1–2.

Small choices, big care

Grownup: cut on the dotted lines. Pick a card, talk, then practise together.



SHARE

Someone wants a turn with your crayons. What could you do?



WELCOME

A child is playing alone. How could you invite them?

TELL THE TRUTH



You made a mistake. Who could you ask for help?



LISTEN

Someone gives you advice. What could you ask before acting?



ENCOURAGE

A friend is finding a task difficult. What could you say?



LEARN

Choose a time to enjoy a Bible passage with a grownup.

Older children: add a respectful sentence you could actually say. Younger children: let a grownup read and model an action.

Encourage the thinking

Suggested responses and a gentle check in

Page 3: answer guidance

1: B, suggest taking turns. 2: A, help someone join. 3: A, tell the truth and ask for help. The final sentence is open ended. Look for a connection between learning God’s teaching and a specific action, not exact wording.

Pages 4 and 5: notice effort

There is no single correct drawing or script. Praise careful thought, willingness to listen and a concrete act of care. Invite children to explain their picture or choice. Support children who prefer pointing, movement or a spoken answer.

A check in after the lesson

What did you notice in the Bible passage?

Which choice will you practise?

Who can help you when you are unsure?

Adapt without pressure

Read aloud as needed. Offer a spoken answer, a drawing or a gesture. Give extra time and a break. In mixed age groups, read together, then use the activity for each child’s stage. An older child can help a younger child without doing the activity for them.

Content note: All explanations and scenarios in this pack are original teaching material. They are not verbatim Scripture. Read Psalm 1:1–2 from a licensed NIV or GNB Bible. Starter pack prepared for review by The Bible Playroom team before use in a class.